

Taking radiology innovation to the remotest corners of the world

Rochi Nargotra, CEO and Director, Phantom Healthcare, discusses how the company is bridging the diagnostic gap by making advanced imaging affordable and accessible for hospitals in India's tier 2 and tier 3 cities, rural regions and emerging global markets—ensuring quality diagnostics reach patients beyond metros

Phantom Healthcare's mission: Bridging the diagnostic divide across continents

In the world of medical diagnostics, geography should never determine the quality of care a patient receives. Yet, for millions living in India's tier 2 and tier 3 cities, rural villages, tribal belts, and across developing nations in Africa, the Middle East, and South-East Asia, access to advanced diagnostic imaging has long been a distant dream. Phantom Healthcare was founded on a simple yet powerful belief: every patient, regardless of where they live, deserves access to accurate, timely, and affordable diagnostic imaging.

The challenge: Healthcare's last mile

India's tier 2 and tier 3 cities, along with rural and tribal areas, face a perfect storm of healthcare challenges. Limited budgets, lack of infrastructure, shortage of trained personnel, and the prohibitive cost of new medical equipment create insurmountable barriers for local healthcare facilities. Patients in these regions often travel hundreds of kilometres to urban centres for basic diagnostic procedures like



MRI or CT scans — a journey that is not only physically exhausting but can delay critical diagnoses and treatment.

The situation in many African, Middle Eastern, and Southeast Asian countries mirrors these challenges. With healthcare budgets stretched thin and infrastructure still developing, advanced diagnostic imaging remains largely concentrated in major cities, leaving vast populations underserved.

Phantom Healthcare's solution: Affordable excellence

Since 2011, Phantom Healthcare has specialised in providing high-quality refurbished medical imaging equipment at 40-60 per cent lower

costs compared to new systems. This cost-effectiveness is not just about affordability — it's about making the impossible possible for smaller hospitals and diagnostic centres.

Our refurbished MRI Machines, CT Scanners, PET-CT Systems, Cath Labs, Gamma Cameras, and Bone Densitometers undergo rigorous quality checks and meet international standards. Each system is meticulously restored, tested, and certified before installation. Healthcare facilities get the same diagnostic capabilities as metropolitan hospitals, but at a fraction of the investment.

Real impact: Stories from the field

India's heartland: Our work in Chhattisgarh exemplifies the transformative impact of accessible imaging technology. This state, with significant tribal populations and remote areas, has long struggled with access to healthcare. Our installations here have enabled local hospitals to provide advanced diagnostics without requiring patients to travel to Raipur or other major cities.

This commitment was recently

recognised when Shri Shyam Bihari Jaiswal, Hon'ble Health Minister of Chhattisgarh, visited our stall at the IRIA Chhattisgarh 2025 conference. He praised our AI-powered predictive analytics, cost-effective solutions, and most importantly, our dedication to serving tribal and remote areas. His words — "Companies like Phantom Healthcare reaching tribal areas of Chhattisgarh are vital for the nation's healthcare" — affirm our mission and inspire us to expand further.

Expanding across Africa: Many African nations are investing in healthcare infrastructure, but they face budget constraints that make procuring new equipment difficult. Phantom Healthcare has been actively expanding across the continent, providing refurbished imaging solutions that enable hospitals and diagnostic centres to establish or upgrade their radiology departments. The combination of affordability, quality, and reliable after-sales service has made us a trusted partner, helping African healthcare facilities leapfrog infrastructure gaps.

Middle East and Gulf presence: Through our registered office in Sharjah (UAE), we serve the Gulf and Middle Eastern markets with comprehensive service packages, repairs, spare parts, and technical support. Our AERB and NABL-accredited regulatory expertise helps facilities in these regions maintain compliance while optimising operational efficiency.

South-East Asian outreach: Our expanding footprint in South-East Asian countries addresses similar challenges of healthcare



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accessibility in smaller cities and rural areas, providing cost-effective alternatives to expensive new equipment.

Global standards, local expertise: With our registered office in Chicago, USA, we leverage American technology partnerships — notably our collaboration with Glassbeam Inc. for AI-powered remote monitoring — bringing global innovations to local healthcare challenges worldwide.

Beyond equipment: Building sustainable healthcare ecosystems

Our approach goes beyond selling equipment. We provide:

Comprehensive service support: AMC/CMC packages, repairs, and 24/7 technical assistance ensure uninterrupted operations

Training and capacity building:

We train local technicians and radiologists on equipment operation and maintenance

Spare parts availability: One of India's largest spare parts inventories means minimal downtime, even in remote locations

AI-powered monitoring: Real-time equipment health monitoring and predictive maintenance reduce downtime globally

The road ahead

With over 500+ installations across India, registered offices in India, UAE, and USA, and a growing presence across Africa, the Middle East, the Gulf, and South-East Asia, our mission is clear: continue expanding the reach of quality diagnostic imaging to every corner where it's needed. Our recently opened Pune office strengthens our ability to serve Southern and Western India's tier 2 and tier 3 cities more effectively.

Conclusion: Healthcare without boundaries

At Phantom Healthcare, we measure our success not in units sold, but in lives impacted — the tribal patient in Chhattisgarh who no longer needs to travel 200 kilometres for an MRI, the small-town hospital in Africa that can now offer PET-CT scans, the diagnostic centre in rural India that can finally compete with urban facilities.

Taking radiology innovation to the remotest corners isn't just our business model — it's our responsibility, our passion, and our commitment to a future where quality healthcare knows no boundaries.